



Heartbleed hackers

Hackers are on the lookout for Heartbleed affected websites to get easier targets
<http://dgit.in/HackBleed>

Zeus cozies up to India

India has been found to be the third most attacked nation by the Zeus malware that steals sensitive information
<http://dgit.in/1stEqSE>

Heartbleed, and more

Heartbleed has sent alarm bells ringing across the world fearing millions of passwords, credit card numbers and other sensitive information open to hackers. We take a detailed look at the Heartbleed bug and other important developments in the security segment.

Hearthbleed – a recently uncovered security bug – has triggered a panic globally. While many of you want to believe Heartbleed OpenSSL vulnerability is overblown, it appears the bug is much worse than our imagination. In fact, Heartbleed is being considered as the biggest and most widespread vulnerabilities in the history of the modern web.

Heartbleed is a bug within open source protocol “OpenSSL”, which is widely used to encrypt web communications. Several web giants like Google, Amazon, Yahoo etc. use the protocol.

Researchers from security testing and software company Codenomicon and Google, who found the vulnerability, explain that Heartbleed allows stealing information protected, under normal conditions, by the SSL/TLS encryption used to secure the Internet. SSL/TLS provides communication security and privacy over the Internet for applications such as web, email, instant messaging (IM) and some virtual private networks (VPNs).

“The Heartbleed bug allows anyone on the Internet to read the memory of the systems protected by the vulnerable versions of the OpenSSL software. This compromises the secret keys used to identify the service providers and to encrypt the traffic and the actual content. This allows attackers to

eavesdrop on communications, steal data directly from the services and users and to impersonate services and users,” add researchers.

A fix for OpenSSL has already been released and deployed. However, Operating system vendors and distribution, appliance vendors, independent software vendors have to adopt the fix and notify their

knew about the heartbleed vulnerability for at least two years and used it regularly to gather critical information.

NSA, however, denied this, stating that they became aware of the vulnerability only after it was made public in a cyber security report.

“The Federal government relies on OpenSSL to protect the privacy of users of govern-

“Shortly after news of the Heartbleed Bug first surfaced, Kaspersky Lab uncovered evidence that a few hacking groups believed to be involved in state-sponsored cyber espionage were running such scans. Later, the Team at Kaspersky Lab identified such scans coming from ‘tens’ of actors. The numbers were gradually increasing and this was even more evident when security software company Rapid7 released a free tool for conducting such scans. This problem is insidious and devices besides servers could be at risk because they run software programs with vulnerable OpenSSL code built into them,” said Kurt Baumgartner, Researcher - Kaspersky Lab in a statement.



The heartbleed bug

users. Service providers and users have to install the fix as it becomes available for the operating systems, networked appliances and software they use.

Major services such as Google have already released security patches in this regard. While BlackBerry has plans to release a security patch for BBM, Twitter in an update says it is monitoring the situation.

Did the NSA know about it?

A Bloomberg report citing unidentified sources alleged the US’ National Security Agency (NSA)

ment websites and other online services. This Administration takes seriously its responsibility to help maintain an open, interoperable, secure and reliable Internet. If the Federal government, including the intelligence community, had discovered this vulnerability prior to last week, it would have been disclosed to the community responsible for OpenSSL,” says the security agency in a statement.

Kaspersky Labs claims that it has uncovered evidence of a few hacker groups being involved in state-sponsored cyber espionage were running such scans.

Alerts in Indian cyberspace

The Indian cybersecurity sleuths issued an alert against Heartbleed:

“A remote attacker could exploit this vulnerability by submitting crafted TLS or DTLS heartbeat packets to an affected device to retrieve sensitive information, such as private keys, user name and passwords or contents of encrypted traffic from process memory. By leveraging this information, an attacker may be able to decrypt, spoof, or perform man-in-the-middle attacks,” says the Computer Emergency Response Team of India (CERT-In) in its latest advisory.